

The Chromatic Scale

Twelve half steps from any note to the same note an octave higher — every pitch in between, with none left out.

SMALLEST MOVE

Half step

Next-door notes. A to A[#], or B to C.

TWO HALF STEPS

Whole step

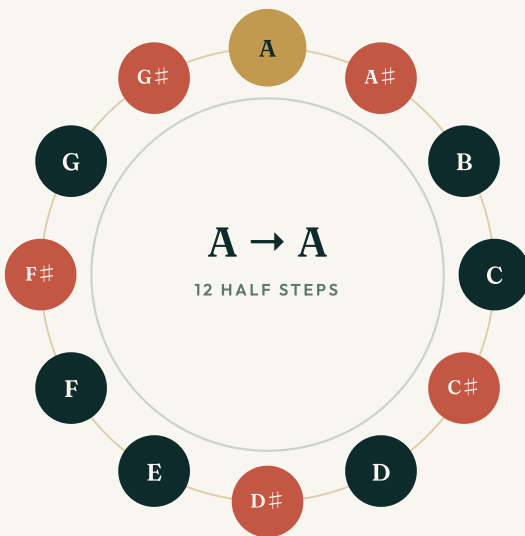
Skip one pitch. A to B, or D to E.

TWELVE HALF STEPS

Octave

Same note name, higher. A up to the next A.

AROUND THE OCTAVE · STARTING ON A



THE MUSICAL ALPHABET

Seven letter names

A

B

C

D

E

F

G

Sharps (#) raise a note one half step. Flats (b) lower it one half step. A[#] and B^b are the same pitch — two names for one sound.

B → C

Already a half step. There is no sharp or flat between them.

E → F

Already a half step. Same story — they sit right next to each other.

THE TWELVE NOTES · FROM A TO A

